

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 5: The Rise of Empires

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	5 — The Rise of Empires
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. The chapter's classic traps are confusing the spoken language Prakrit with the Brahmi script, imagining Alexander conquered all of India, assuming an emperor governed every village in person, reversing the Kalinga-to-Dhamma sequence, and muddling the order of the Nanda, Maurya and Ashokan milestones. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. A textbook draws this contrast: 'In the place X, a single ruler's commands stop at his own frontier; in the place Y, several crowned rulers still keep their seats yet none may overrule one paramount lord.' What single structural property does Y possess that X lacks?
- (A) A guarantee of greater total wealth than X could ever hold
 - (B) A standing army that X by definition is forbidden to keep
 - (C) A larger sweep of territory, which alone makes Y an empire and X not
 - (D) Layered sovereignty, in which subordinate kings remain on their thrones but are subordinated to one supreme overlord
2. An emperor leaves a beaten king on his throne in return for yearly gold, grain and elephants; a different region he instead places under a salaried governor who owns no realm of his own. Which statement correctly contrasts the two arrangements AND gives the shared purpose both serve?

- (A) The first is a satrap and the second a tributary, but both free the emperor from ever keeping an army
- (B) The first is a tributary who keeps his kingdom while paying tribute and the second a satrap who is merely an appointee; both let the overlord control distant land without governing it in person
- (C) Both are tributaries differing only in the goods they send, and both exist chiefly to choose the next emperor
- (D) The first is an appointed official and the second a throne-holding king, and both rule larger lands than the emperor himself

3. Of the six supports an empire must maintain, which pairing wrongly matches a support to the problem it is meant to solve?

- (A) An administration of officials paired with extending the centre's authority into regions the emperor cannot personally visit
- (B) A common currency, weights and measures paired with letting distant regions trade and be taxed under one shared system
- (C) A strong army paired with defending the frontiers and enforcing the emperor's authority
- (D) A thriving economy paired with carrying commands and troops swiftly across great distances

4. Why does the chapter treat a thriving economy as the support on which the army, the officials and the communication networks all rest, rather than as just one support among equals?

- (A) Because the wealth that trade and taxes generate is what actually pays for the army, the officials and the roads, so without it the other supports cannot be funded
- (B) Because a flourishing economy removes any need for the emperor to collect tribute from subordinate kings
- (C) Because economic strength on its own, with no army or officials at all, was enough to hold an empire together
- (D) Because the economy mattered only as a source of fine coins, which the empire prized chiefly as works of art

5. Two provinces of one empire begin using different coins and different weights and measures from each other. Following the chapter's reasoning, what is the most likely chain of consequences?

- (A) The empire's army automatically grows stronger because each province now funds its own troops
- (B) The emperor can suddenly govern each province directly, with no further need for officials

- (C) Both provinces immediately raise more food and mine more iron than before
- (D) Trade between them and uniform taxation across them both become harder, so the empire's revenue and economic unity weaken

6. A king deliberately lets the weavers' shreni fix its own fair prices, elect its own honest head and settle its own quarrels. Reading the chapter's logic, what is the king's real motive, and what would he risk by instead policing the guild with soldiers day to day?

- (A) His motive is that self-running guilds keep trade and tax revenue flowing; heavy policing would disrupt the orderly commerce that fed his treasury
- (B) His motive is that he is legally forbidden to touch trade; policing would simply break that law without other effect
- (C) His motive is that guilds pay no taxes at all; policing would be pointless because there is nothing to gain from them
- (D) His motive is that he lacks any power to interfere; policing would fail because guilds outrank the king

7. Whoever controlled the Uttarapatha and the Dakshinapatha gained an advantage that fed several supports of empire at once. Which statement best captures that combined advantage?

- (A) They were the fixed permanent borders of every Indian empire, so holding them defined the empire's edge
- (B) They were the great sea lanes that gave India command over ocean trade
- (C) These overland arteries carried goods, news and troops between far regions, so controlling them brought taxable trade, swift communication and military reach together
- (D) They were built solely so Ashoka could send his edicts to the provinces

8. An empire keeps a vast army, capable officials, a common currency and excellent roads, yet pointedly neglects support for art and learning. Using the chapter's framework, which weakness is it MOST likely to develop, and why is that weakness distinct from the others?

- (A) It will be unable to collect any tribute from its provinces, because tribute depends on patronage of the arts
- (B) It will lose every soldier within a year, because armies cannot exist without poets and scholars
- (C) It will be unable to build even a single fort, because forts require artists to design them
- (D) It will lack the shared culture that binds diverse peoples, a cohesion that force and administration cannot by themselves supply

9. Iron from the hills near Magadha is said to have strengthened it in two distinct ways at once, touching two different supports of empire. Which option names both effects AND the support each one served?

(A) Iron ships built a navy for sea trade, while iron coins served as the empire's currency

(B) Iron ploughs raised food output, feeding the economy and population, while iron weapons armed a strong military

(C) Iron was sold abroad for gold, while iron was also paid as tribute to other kings

(D) Iron temples drew worshippers, while iron pillars carried the edicts

10. Among the sixteen mahajanapadas, only Magadha rose to imperial greatness. Which single line best explains WHY its bundle of advantages mattered, rather than merely listing them?

(A) Great seaports and a powerful navy let it command ocean trade that the inland kingdoms could not reach

(B) Fertile soil fed a large population, iron armed and equipped it, elephant forests supplied war-power, and the rivers cheaply moved goods and troops, so the advantages reinforced one another

(C) Gold mines and control of the distant Silk Road made it richer than every rival at a stroke

(D) Snowy mountains and a protective cold desert shielded it so well that it never needed an army

11. A student says, 'Mahapadma Nanda was just an ordinary king like the rest.' Which action of his best refutes this by showing a shift toward genuinely imperial rule?

(A) He composed the Arthashastra to set out the science of statecraft

(B) He carved moral edicts onto rock surfaces and stone pillars

(C) He welded many separate kingdoms under one authority while issuing coins and keeping a vast army

(D) He defeated Alexander's army on the banks of the Indus

12. The last Nanda king was immensely wealthy, yet his people's loyalty drained away, and this loss of loyalty is precisely what gave his challenger an opening. The chapter links the lost loyalty to which cause?

(A) He gave the entire treasury away to the poor, leaving the state too weak to defend itself

(B) He refused to mint any coins, so trade ceased and the people blamed him for it

(C) He handed his throne to a Greek satrap, and the people resented foreign rule

(D) He oppressed his subjects and taxed them so heavily that their support collapsed, opening the way for Chandragupta

13. Comparing the Nanda and Maurya states, which single statement is the most accurate, given how their roles and timing relate?

(A) The Mauryas founded the empire and the Nandas later destroyed it

(B) The Nandas first welded Magadha's lands into one large power, and the Mauryas then displaced them and pushed the empire across most of the subcontinent

(C) The Nandas carved edicts on pillars while the Mauryas carved none

(D) The Nandas and the Mauryas ruled at the very same time as bitter rivals

14. The Ganga and the Son were a major advantage to Magadha. Which statement best explains the dual role rivers played for a rising power, as opposed to a single use?

(A) They lowered the cost of moving both trade goods and troops, so they served the economy and the military at once

(B) They were worshipped as gods, so they bound the people religiously to the Nandas

(C) They were the only borders the empire ever recognised, so they fixed its limits

(D) They were rich in iron ore, so they were Magadha's chief source of metal

15. Around 326 BCE Alexander reached the northwest of India only after first overrunning one great power; soon after his victory over Porus he nonetheless turned homeward. Which option correctly names BOTH the empire he had already conquered AND the immediate reason for his retreat?

(A) He had already conquered the Nanda Empire, and he turned back because Chandragupta defeated him

(B) He had already conquered the Maurya Empire, and he turned back when the Nandas paid him tribute to leave

(C) He had already conquered the Roman Empire, and he turned back after running out of weapons

(D) He had already conquered the Persian Empire, and he turned back because his weary soldiers refused to march further east

16. Assertion: Alexander's actual grip on Indian land was thin and short-lived. Reason: He left behind weak Greek governors and opened new contacts rather than firmly ruling Indian territory himself. Choose the best evaluation.

(A) Both are true, but the reason does not explain the assertion

(B) The assertion is true but the reason is false

(C) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion

(D) The assertion is false but the reason is true

17. The chapter says Chandragupta could expand swiftly in the northwest partly because of conditions left after Alexander's departure and death. Which condition helped him most there, and why?

(A) A strong, united Greek army still guarding the northwest, which he won over to his side

(B) A peace treaty Ashoka had already signed for the region, which removed all resistance

(C) The lifelong loyalty of the Nanda soldiers, who had served Chandragupta from birth

(D) The weak Greek satraps left behind, whose hold crumbled after Alexander's death, so Chandragupta could defeat or absorb them

18. Why does the chapter describe Alexander's lasting effect on India as mostly indirect rather than that of a conqueror who reshaped it directly?

- (A) Because he directly governed northern India for about fifty years before dying there
- (B) Because he personally founded the Maurya dynasty that ruled after him
- (C) Because he held no Indian land for long and instead left weak governors and opened contacts, so his influence worked through openings rather than rule
- (D) Because he carved edicts in Greek across India to teach his laws

19. King Porus belongs to this chapter's story of Alexander. Which statement about Porus is correct?

- (A) Porus was the Macedonian general Alexander left behind to govern Indian lands
- (B) Porus was the Greek envoy who later wrote an account of the Mauryan court
- (C) Porus was the northwestern king of the Pauravas whom Alexander defeated in battle near the Indus
- (D) Porus was the Magadhan ruler who founded the Nanda dynasty

20. Place the founders and milestones in correct chronological order: (i) Chandragupta founds the Maurya empire, (ii) Mahapadma Nanda founds the Nanda dynasty, (iii) Ashoka fights the Kalinga war, (iv) Alexander reaches the northwest of India.

- (A) (iv), (ii), (i), (iii)
- (B) (ii), (iv), (i), (iii)
- (C) (ii), (i), (iv), (iii)
- (D) (i), (ii), (iv), (iii)

21. Around 321 BCE Chandragupta founded the Maurya empire. The chapter credits his success chiefly to a combination of which two things?

- (A) Overthrowing the unpopular Nandas with the guidance and strategy of Kautilya
- (B) Being crowned emperor of India by Alexander before the Greek king left
- (C) Inheriting the throne peacefully from his grandson Ashoka
- (D) Marrying into the Persian royal house to borrow its armies

22. The mentor who guided Chandragupta to power went by more than one name and left a famous written work. Which option correctly gives BOTH an alternative name for him AND the nature of that work?

- (A) He was also called Megasthenes, and his Indica is a treatise on governance and economics
- (B) He was also called Chanakya or Vishnugupta, and his Arthashastra is a treatise on the science of governance and economics
- (C) He was also called Panini, and his Arthashastra is a collection of moral edicts
- (D) He was also called Porus, and his Arthashastra is a book of court poetry praising the emperor

23. Kautilya likens the state to a body of seven limbs, the saptanga. Which option correctly names all seven AND states why he insists they must work together?

- (A) King, queen, priests, merchants, farmers, soldiers and slaves; because seven was a number the Mauryas thought lucky
- (B) Land, sea, forests, mines, rivers, hills and cities; because a state is simply the sum of its geography
- (C) King, ministers, territory and people, the fort, the treasury, the army and the allies; if any one limb is weak the whole body, the state, suffers
- (D) Army, navy, cavalry, forts, coins, roads and temples; because military power is the only thing that holds a state

24. In the saptanga the treasury and the army are listed as two separate limbs even though the treasury in fact paid the army. What is the best reason for keeping them distinct?

- (A) Because the treasury and the army were never used at the same time
- (B) Because the army was always paid in grain rather than from the treasury
- (C) They perform different functions, one funding the state's needs and the other defending and enforcing its authority, even while the treasury pays for the army
- (D) Because the treasury belonged to the guilds while the army belonged to the king

25. An emperor obviously cannot watch over every distant province himself. Which option best states the Mauryan answer to this problem AND why a network of spies was added on top of it?

- (A) Provinces were abolished so each village ruled itself, and spies replaced the need for any army
- (B) Each region was handed to the guilds to govern, and spies took the place of the common currency
- (C) The realm was divided into provinces under governors and officials reporting to the centre, and spies let the centre learn what was happening far off and check on those very officials
- (D) The emperor toured every village in person each year, and spies served instead of provincial governors

26. Why was taxation, rather than occasional plunder or gifts, so central to the Mauryan state's strength?

- (A) Because steady, regular tax revenue was what funded the army, the officials and the works of the empire over the long term
- (B) Because taxation was mainly the emperor's tool for punishing provinces that had been disloyal
- (C) Because the taxes existed only to enrich the guilds of the great cities
- (D) Because taxation replaced the need for any trade or economy at all

27. Match each figure to his role: Bindusara, Megasthenes, Kautilya.

(A) Bindusara was Chandragupta's son and Ashoka's father; Megasthenes was the Greek envoy to the Mauryan court; Kautilya was the mentor who wrote the Arthashastra

(B) Bindusara was the Greek envoy; Megasthenes was the mentor-author; Kautilya was Ashoka's father

(C) Bindusara was the mentor-author; Megasthenes was Ashoka's father; Kautilya was the Greek envoy

(D) Bindusara was the founder of the empire; Megasthenes was Chandragupta's son; Kautilya was the last Nanda king

28. Megasthenes and Kautilya are both linked to the Mauryan court, yet what one wrote differs sharply in nature from what the other wrote. Which statement captures that difference correctly?

(A) Megasthenes wrote the Arthashastra on statecraft, while Kautilya wrote the Indica describing the court as an outsider

(B) Megasthenes wrote the Indica, an outsider's eyewitness account of Mauryan India, while Kautilya wrote the Arthashastra, an insider's manual of statecraft

(C) Both wrote religious scriptures, differing only in the language they used

(D) Megasthenes wrote court poetry praising the emperor, while Kautilya carved the rock edicts

29. The dhamma-mahamatras were a special class of Mauryan officials. Reading their title alongside the rest of the administration, what was their distinctive task?

(A) To command the cavalry guarding the empire's frontiers

(B) To collect the yearly tribute from the empire's subordinate kings

(C) To cut the Brahmi letters of the edicts into the rock faces

(D) To spread and oversee the practice of Dhamma, Ashoka's code of moral conduct, among the people

30. A teacher says, 'Mauryan officials simply made the army and the treasury unnecessary.' Why is this the wrong way to describe the role of the administration?

(A) Because the officials existed mainly to compose poetry in praise of the emperor

(B) Because officials extended the centre's authority into far provinces, complementing the army and treasury rather than replacing them, since an empire still needed force and funds

(C) Because officials abolished taxes throughout the empire, leaving no treasury to maintain

(D) Because officials each commanded their own private army, so the imperial army was no longer needed

31. A student argues, 'Ashoka attacked Kalinga in order to spread Buddhism.' Which correction best identifies the error AND restores the true sequence?

- (A) The order is reversed: Ashoka attacked Kalinga to expand his empire, and it was the horror of the bloodshed afterwards that turned him toward Dhamma
- (B) The error is the place: Ashoka never fought a war at Kalinga, so the question of motive does not arise
- (C) The error is the religion: Kalinga had already become Buddhist, so there was nothing for Ashoka to spread there
- (D) The error is the rule: Buddhism forbade any king from ever waging war, so Ashoka could not have fought at all

32. How can historians be confident that Ashoka was genuinely shaken by the Kalinga war, rather than merely claiming so for show, given the sources available?

- (A) Because Megasthenes described Ashoka's grief in detail in the Indica
- (B) Because Ashoka openly recorded his own remorse over the slaughter in his edicts, leaving us his sorrow in his own words
- (C) Because Kautilya wrote about Ashoka's remorse in the Arthashastra
- (D) Because a much later king built a temple specifically to commemorate Ashoka's sorrow

33. Suppose Ashoka had felt no remorse after Kalinga and simply kept conquering. Following the chapter's logic, what is the most likely consequence?

- (A) The Maurya empire would have collapsed that very same year
- (B) The Brahmi script would never have been deciphered by later scholars
- (C) Chandragupta, his grandfather, would somehow have lost his throne
- (D) He might have waged further aggressive wars, and the Dhamma edicts that we read today would never have been composed

34. Ashoka's idea of Dhamma is best understood as which of the following?

- (A) A brand-new religion meant to replace Buddhism throughout the empire
- (B) A special tax demanded each year from the tributary kings
- (C) A broad code of moral and ethical conduct, urging honesty, non-violence, tolerance and the truthful doing of one's duties, addressed to all subjects
- (D) The science of warfare and battlefield strategy taught to his officers

35. At its height Ashoka's empire covered nearly the whole subcontinent. Which option correctly names the one notable region it did NOT include AND a region that it did include?

- (A) It excluded the Ganga plains around Pataliputra but included the far south
- (B) It excluded the far south of the peninsula but included the northwest reaching toward parts of Afghanistan
- (C) It excluded the northwest near Afghanistan but included only the eastern lands
- (D) It excluded the eastern lands toward modern Bangladesh but excluded the Ganga plains as well

36. Ashoka is praised as a 'great communicator.' Which option best explains the means he used AND why that means suited the goal of reaching many people across a vast empire?

- (A) He sent soldiers to recite his words aloud in every village, ensuring each person heard them once
- (B) He engraved edicts on rocks and stone pillars across the empire, a durable and public medium that could reach people in many far-flung places
- (C) He printed books for every household, so the message reached homes directly
- (D) He built one great central temple, so that all his subjects could gather to hear the message

37. Ashoka's edicts were composed mainly in the everyday Prakrit language and written in the Brahmi script. A classmate says, 'Prakrit and Brahmi are just two names for the same thing.' Which correction is right?

- (A) Brahmi is the spoken language and Prakrit is the script used to write it
- (B) Prakrit is a language that people spoke, while Brahmi is a script, a way of writing it down, so they belong to different categories
- (C) Both are scripts, and only the Greeks ever used either of them
- (D) Both are languages, and neither of them is a script at all

38. Why might Ashoka have chosen the everyday Prakrit language rather than refined Sanskrit, AND why carve the messages on stone rather than write them on cloth or paper?

- (A) Sanskrit had not yet been invented, and paper and cloth did not yet exist anywhere
- (B) Prakrit was a secret tongue kept from commoners, and stone was simply the cheapest material available
- (C) Prakrit was common speech so ordinary people could understand directly, and stone was permanent and public, surviving weather and centuries
- (D) Prakrit was the only language that could be carved, and Brahmi could only ever be written on stone

39. Beyond their use by Ashoka, the Brahmi script and the Prakrit language each have a lasting significance. Which option states each correctly?

- (A) Brahmi is identical to the modern Roman alphabet, and Prakrit was a refined court language few could speak
- (B) Brahmi has never been deciphered by scholars, and Prakrit was a secret code of the priests
- (C) Brahmi is the ancestor from which most of today's Indian scripts descend, and Prakrit was the everyday spoken language of the common people of the time
- (D) Brahmi was a spoken language used only in the Mauryan court, and Prakrit was the script used to record it

40. The Mauryan artwork chosen as independent India's national emblem, the place it once crowned, and the wheel later set at the centre of the national flag are connected. Which option links all three correctly?

- (A) The Great Stupa at Sanchi became the national emblem, and the flag's wheel is the wheel of a Mauryan war chariot
- (B) The rock-cut elephant at Dhauuli became the national emblem, and the flag's wheel symbolises the empire's trade routes
- (C) The terracotta dancing figure became the national emblem, and the flag's wheel is the sun worshipped by the Mauryan kings
- (D) The Lion Capital that crowned Ashoka's pillar at Sarnath became the national emblem, and the dharmachakra on the flag, the wheel of dharma, is drawn from the same Mauryan art

41. On the 'Lion Capital of Sarnath,' the word capital is an architectural term, and the site of Sarnath was chosen for a particular reason. Which option gets BOTH right?

- (A) The capital is the empire's capital city, and Sarnath was chosen because it was where Ashoka was crowned emperor
- (B) The capital is the carved top, or crowning head, of the stone column, and Sarnath was chosen because it was where the Buddha gave his first teaching
- (C) The capital is the empire's treasury, and Sarnath was chosen because it was where the Kalinga war was fought
- (D) The capital is the main edict carved on the pillar, and Sarnath was chosen because Chandragupta there defeated the Nandas

42. The Maurya empire is said to have ended around 185 BCE, while Ashoka died in 232 BCE. What does the gap between these dates tell us, and how does it bear on the chapter's larger argument?

- (A) The empire fell within about half a century of Ashoka's death, showing how fast even a great empire can unravel once its strongest ruler is gone
- (B) The empire fell roughly two centuries after his death, showing how stable empires usually were
- (C) The empire fell within a single year of his death, proving that an empire dies the moment its emperor does
- (D) The empire fell more than three hundred years after his death, showing it long outlived its greatest king

43. The chapter calls empires both fragile and a paradox. Which single statement best captures the paradox AND the reason for the fragility together?

- (A) An empire is at once very small and very large, and it is fragile because it never keeps an army to defend itself
- (B) An empire has an emperor but no kings beneath him, and it is fragile because it refuses to collect any tribute

(C) An empire collects tribute but spends nothing on an army, and it is fragile because it has too much wealth to defend

(D) An empire can bring unity and prosperity yet rests on force and tribute, so when the centre weakens distant regions break away and even the greatest fall

44. By the chapter's reasoning, which combination of circumstances would MOST tempt a distant province to break away from an empire?

(A) A weak emperor following a strong one, combined with heavier tribute demands, giving the province both opportunity and grievance

(B) A succession of strong emperors, each keeping the provinces firmly in check

(C) Lower tribute demands during a long stretch of peace and prosperity

(D) The building of better roads that tie the province more closely to the capital

45. A historian unearths an Ashokan rock edict, in Prakrit and Brahmi, near a far frontier of the empire, and finds many more across different regions. What is the spread of such edicts MOST useful for telling us, and why does it not tell us the other things?

(A) It tells us the exact year in which Alexander was born, because edicts always record royal birthdays

(B) It tells us the day-to-day price of iron in Magadha's markets, because edicts list market prices

(C) It traces roughly how far Ashoka's empire and influence reached, because the edicts were placed across the lands he controlled

(D) It tells us the precise number of guilds in each Mauryan city, because edicts register every guild

46. Which of the following is NOT one of the six supports the chapter says an empire must maintain?

(A) Holding regular elections to choose the emperor

(B) A strong army to defend and enforce its authority

(C) Communication networks to move orders, troops and news across distance

(D) Support for art and learning to bind diverse peoples through a common culture

47. Bindusara is sometimes overlooked between two more famous Mauryas. Which statement places him correctly in the dynasty?

(A) He was the son of Chandragupta and the father of Ashoka, ruling between the founder and the great Dhamma emperor

(B) He was the mentor of Chandragupta who wrote the Arthashastra

(C) He was the Greek envoy who described the Mauryan court in the Indica

(D) He was the founder of the dynasty who overthrew the Nandas

48. Suppose the last Nanda king had ruled justly and kept his people's loyalty. Following the chapter's reasoning about why he fell, what is the most likely effect?

- (A) The Nanda dynasty might have lasted longer and better resisted Chandragupta's challenge, since it was lost loyalty that opened the way for him
- (B) Ashoka would never have been born into the world
- (C) Alexander would then have conquered the whole of India
- (D) Kautilya would have written two separate copies of the Arthashastra

49. A well-planned, prosperous and food-secure Mauryan city is described in the chapter. Which two supports of empire does such a city most directly illustrate working together?

- (A) The absence of any army and the absence of a common currency
- (B) A reliance on tribute alone with no economy behind it
- (C) A strong administration and control over resources, planning the city and securing its food
- (D) A refusal to support art and learning combined with isolation from trade

50. Why does the chapter argue that a strong army, though essential, cannot by itself hold an empire together?

- (A) Because an army is hugely expensive, so without a thriving economy and steady tax revenue it cannot be paid or maintained
- (B) Because an army is by rule forbidden from entering the empire's distant provinces
- (C) Because soldiers were unpaid volunteers, so the cost of an army was never a concern
- (D) Because the frontiers were defended entirely by tributary kings, so the emperor kept no army at all

51. Taking the chapter as a whole, which statement best expresses its deepest lesson about empires?

- (A) Once founded, an empire endures forever, unchanged by the strength of its rulers
- (B) An empire needs only a single strong emperor and nothing else to last
- (C) Tribute by itself, with neither army nor administration, is enough to rule an empire
- (D) Building an empire is hard but holding one together is harder still, so even the greatest empires eventually decline

52. Why was a network of communication, such as well-maintained routes and messengers, indispensable to a far-flung empire, in a way that an army alone could not substitute for?

- (A) Because it replaced the need for any army, since fast messages could defend the frontier
- (B) Because it served chiefly to collect tribute, taking over the work of the officials
- (C) Because it allowed the emperor to abolish the common currency he no longer needed
- (D) Because it carried orders, troops and news swiftly across great distances, so the centre could actually direct affairs in regions the emperor never saw

53. The word empire derives from the Latin imperium. The chapter draws on this origin chiefly to make which point?

- (A) That all empires were ultimately ruled by Roman emperors
- (B) That empires were always given their names in Latin by their founders
- (C) That an empire rests on one ruler holding supreme power, imperium, over many lands and lesser rulers
- (D) That an empire is simply any kingdom that has grown very wealthy

54. A new empire arises with a strong army, officials and good roads, but it allows each region to keep its own different coins and measures. Which support is it failing to maintain, and what is the most likely result?

- (A) It is failing to maintain an army, so its frontiers will be overrun within the year
- (B) It is failing to maintain communication networks, so no orders can reach the provinces
- (C) It is failing to maintain a common currency, weights and measures, so trade across regions and uniform taxation both become harder, weakening its economy
- (D) It is failing to maintain support for art and learning, so it will lose all its officials

55. Both the Persian Empire and the Maurya empire appear in the chapter's account of Alexander's era. Which statement about their relation to Alexander is correct?

- (A) Alexander conquered both the Persian and the Maurya empires before turning home
- (B) Alexander had conquered the Persian Empire before reaching India, whereas the Maurya empire did not yet exist and was founded only a few years after he left
- (C) Alexander conquered the Maurya empire but left the Persian Empire untouched
- (D) Both the Persian and the Maurya empires defeated Alexander and drove him out of Asia

56. Why does the chapter present an emperor's reliance on tributaries, satraps and a body of officials as a single connected solution rather than three unrelated facts?

- (A) Because all three are ways of extending the emperor's authority over lands too distant for him to govern in person
- (B) Because all three were means of choosing the next emperor when the throne fell vacant
- (C) Because all three existed mainly to compose praise-poetry for the emperor
- (D) Because all three were ways of avoiding the need to collect any tribute or taxes

57. A guild, or shreni, of merchants fixes fair prices, shares news of demand, elects an honest head and settles disputes by its own rules; the chapter says wise kings usually left such guilds to govern themselves. Which single conclusion best follows from both facts together?

- (A) The guilds were really run day to day by the king's own soldiers, who only seemed to let them self-govern
- (B) The guilds existed purely to collect tribute on the king's behalf, which is why he tolerated them
- (C) The guilds were tiny family workshops with no shared rules, so there was nothing for the king to control
- (D) Self-governing guilds kept craft and trade orderly and prosperous, and that prosperity fed the king's tax revenue, so it served his interest to leave them alone

58. Comparing how a tributary king and a satrap each relate to the land they oversee, which statement is exactly right?

- (A) A tributary is an appointed official with no realm, while a satrap is a king who keeps his throne
- (B) A tributary keeps his own throne while paying tribute, whereas a satrap is an appointed governor who owns no kingdom of his own
- (C) A tributary always rules a far larger territory than the overlord himself, unlike a satrap
- (D) A tributary is by rule always Greek, while a satrap is by rule always Indian

59. Two sources, Megasthenes' Indica and Ashoka's rock edicts, are both used by historians, yet one is far more useful for learning how Ashoka himself thought, while the other is more useful as an outsider's snapshot. Which statement matches each source to its strength correctly?

- (A) The edicts, being Ashoka's own words inscribed for his people, best reveal his thinking, while the Indica, an outsider's account, best gives a foreign observer's snapshot of Mauryan India
- (B) The Indica, written by Ashoka himself, best reveals his thinking, while the edicts, written by a foreigner, give the outsider's snapshot
- (C) Both sources are Ashoka's own compositions, so neither offers any outside view at all
- (D) Both sources are foreign reports, so neither tells us anything directly from Ashoka

60. Which sequence correctly orders these turning points within the Mauryan story itself: (i) Chandragupta founds the empire, (ii) Bindusara rules, (iii) Ashoka fights the Kalinga war, (iv) the Maurya empire ends around 185 BCE?

- (A) (ii), (i), (iii), (iv)
- (B) (i), (iii), (ii), (iv)
- (C) (i), (ii), (iv), (iii)
- (D) (i), (ii), (iii), (iv)

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 5: The Rise of Empires — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	C	21	A	31	A	41	B	51	D
2	B	12	D	22	B	32	B	42	A	52	D
3	D	13	B	23	C	33	D	43	D	53	C
4	A	14	A	24	C	34	C	44	A	54	C
5	D	15	D	25	C	35	B	45	C	55	B
6	A	16	C	26	A	36	B	46	A	56	A
7	C	17	D	27	A	37	B	47	A	57	D
8	D	18	C	28	B	38	C	48	A	58	B
9	B	19	C	29	D	39	C	49	C	59	A
10	B	20	B	30	B	40	D	50	A	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) Y is an empire and X a kingdom; the essential difference the contrast pins down is the stacking of authority, with lesser kings kept on their thrones beneath one paramount ruler. The option about guaranteed wealth treats a frequent consequence as the defining trait, and an empire is not defined by being richer. A kingdom is not barred from keeping an army, so that option invents a rule. Greater area can accompany an empire but is not what structurally separates it from a kingdom; a very large kingdom would still not be an empire without subordinated kings.

2. (B) A throne-keeping king paying tribute is a tributary, while a salaried, realm-less appointee is a satrap, and both devices let an emperor reach lands he cannot personally rule, so the correct option names each rightly and states the shared aim. The option that swaps the labels reverses the two definitions and falsely says they end the need for an army. Calling both tributaries ignores that the governor holds no kingdom, and empires had no elections to 'choose' an emperor. The last option again swaps the definitions and absurdly makes subordinates larger than the overlord.

3. (D) Carrying orders, soldiers and news quickly across distance is the job of communication networks, not of the economy, so pairing a thriving economy with that task is the mismatched pair the question asks for. An administration of officials really does extend the centre's reach into far regions, a common currency and standard measures really do enable trade and uniform taxation, and a strong army really does defend frontiers and enforce authority, so those three pairings are all correct and therefore not the answer.

4. (A) Armies, officials and roads all cost money, and that money flows from a flourishing economy and its taxes, which is exactly why the chapter treats wealth as the foundation under the other supports. A strong economy does not make tribute pointless, since tribute remained a normal channel of imperial wealth. Wealth alone could not hold an empire without force and administration, so that option overstates the economy. Coins served the economy as money rather than as prized art, so the last option mistakes their purpose.

5. (D) When money and measures differ, merchants struggle to value and exchange goods across the two provinces and the state cannot tax them evenly, so commerce and revenue both suffer and economic unity frays, which is the chapter's logic. A fractured economy does not magically strengthen the army, does not let the emperor abolish officials, and has no power to boost food or iron output; those three options assert effects the chapter's reasoning does not support.

6. (A) Letting guilds govern themselves kept production and trade humming, and that prosperity fed the king's treasury through taxes, so disrupting it with constant policing would choke the very revenue he wanted, which matches the chapter. No law barred kings from trade, guilds and their members were in fact taxed, and guilds did not outrank the king; those three options rest on inventions the chapter contradicts.

7. (C) The two routes were long-distance overland arteries, and command of them meant taxing rich flows of goods while also moving armies and information, so the correct option ties together economy, communication and military reach. They were routes, not borders, and they were overland rather than ocean lanes, so two options misclassify them. Ashoka's edicts came generations later and were not the reason the routes mattered, so the last option reverses cause and date.

8. (D) Patronage of art and learning fosters a common culture that unites varied subjects, so neglecting it leaves an empire materially strong but culturally loose, a gap that force and bureaucracy cannot fill, which is exactly the chapter's point. Tribute depends on the army and administration the empire still has, soldiers depend on pay from a working economy, and forts depend on resources and labour, so none of those three would vanish merely because art is neglected.

9. (B) Iron tools such as ploughs let farmers work the heavy Ganga soil and grow more food, aiding the economy, while iron weapons equipped a strong army, so one resource served two different supports. Magadha was an inland power, not a navy of iron ships, and

iron coins are not what the chapter credits, so the navy-and-coins option is wrong. The chapter does not attribute its rise to iron exports or to paying tribute in iron, and edict pillars came later under Ashoka, so the last two options invent uses the chapter does not give.

10. (B) Magadha's edge was a self-reinforcing bundle: rich farmland fed people, iron made tools and weapons, elephant forests added war-power, and the Ganga and Son moved goods and armies cheaply, so the correct option explains how the advantages worked together. Magadha was an inland power, so seaports and a navy are wrong; it did not rely on gold mines or the Silk Road; and it was not ringed by mountains and desert, nor could it forgo an army, so all three distractors describe a different setting.

11. (C) Uniting many kingdoms, minting coins and maintaining a huge army are imperial-scale acts, so this is what marks Mahapadma Nanda as pushing Magadha toward empire. The Arthashastra was Kautilya's work under the Mauryas, edicts on rock and pillar were Ashoka's, and the Nandas never fought Alexander, who turned back far short of Magadha, so each of those three belongs to someone else or never happened.

12. (D) Dhana Nanda's wealth came at his subjects' expense through oppression and crushing taxes, which is why loyalty collapsed and Chandragupta found support to overthrow him, so the correct option matches the chapter's cause-and-effect. He did not impoverish himself by giving the treasury away, he was not noted for refusing to mint coins, and he never surrendered his throne to a Greek; he was ousted by Chandragupta and Kautilya, so the three distractors invent the cause.

13. (B) The Nandas were the first to unify Magadha into a large power, and the Mauryas then took over and expanded much further, so the correct option captures their sequence and roles. The Mauryas, not the Nandas, built the great empire, only Ashoka of the Mauryas carved edicts, and the two dynasties were successive rather than simultaneous rivals, so each distractor reverses the order or the facts.

14. (A) Cheap river transport moved goods to market and armies to the field, serving the economy and the military together, which is the dual role the chapter highlights. The chapter does not credit river-worship as the source of Magadha's strength, the rivers were arteries rather than fixed borders, and the iron came from nearby hills rather than from the rivers, so the three distractors each misstate the rivers' role.

15. (D) Alexander's eastward march carried him over the Persian Empire before he touched Indian soil, and after beating Porus his exhausted troops mutinied against advancing, which forced his return, so the correct option pairs both facts. He never reached the distant Nandas and was not defeated by Chandragupta; the Maurya empire did not yet exist and the Nandas did not buy him off; and Rome lay far to the west and was never his conquest, so each distractor is doubly false.

16. (C) Alexander's territorial hold was indeed thin and brief precisely because he installed feeble satraps and opened contacts instead of consolidating direct rule, so both statements are true and the reason accounts for the assertion. The option saying the reason does not explain it misses that causal link; the option calling the reason false denies the documented weak governors; and the option calling the assertion false ignores that his Indian rule really was shallow.

17. (D) Alexander left feeble governors whose grip collapsed after his death, giving Chandragupta easy gains in the northwest, so that is the condition that helped him most. A strong united Greek army would have blocked rather than helped him, no Ashokan treaty existed because Ashoka came two generations later, and the Nanda soldiers were not his by birth since he had to overthrow the Nandas, so the three distractors are each impossible by date or fact.

18. (C) Alexander never firmly held Indian territory; he left weak satraps and opened new contacts, so his real mark was indirect, working through the openings he created rather than through lasting rule, which matches the chapter. He did not govern India for fifty years, he did not found the Maurya dynasty, which Chandragupta did, and the edicts were Ashoka's later work in Prakrit and Brahmi, not Greek inscriptions by Alexander, so the three distractors all overstate a direct role he never had.

19. (C) Porus ruled the Pauravas in the northwest and was defeated by Alexander near the Indus, so the correct option places him rightly. He was an Indian king, not a Macedonian governor, so the first distractor confuses him with a satrap; the Greek envoy who described the Mauryan court was Megasthenes, not Porus; and the Nanda dynasty was founded by Mahapadma Nanda, so the last two distractors swap him for entirely different figures.

20. (B) The Nandas rose first in the fifth century BCE, Alexander arrived about 326 BCE, Chandragupta founded the Maurya empire about 321 BCE, and Ashoka's Kalinga war came later in the third century BCE, giving the order Nanda, Alexander, Chandragupta, Kalinga. The option starting with Alexander wrongly puts him before the Nandas, the option placing Chandragupta before Alexander reverses 321 and 326 BCE, and the option starting with Chandragupta puts the Maurya founding before the Nandas, so all three break the established sequence.

21. (A) Chandragupta seized power by toppling the hated Nandas with the help of the strategist Kautilya, so the correct option names both the act and the mentor. Alexander did not crown him, the throne could not be inherited from Ashoka, who was Chandragupta's own grandson and ruled much later, and the chapter credits no Persian marriage, so each distractor either reverses the family order or invents foreign backing.

22. (B) Kautilya was also known as Chanakya and Vishnugupta, and his Arthashastra is a manual of statecraft and economics, so the correct option ties the right names to the right kind of book. Megasthenes was the Greek envoy who wrote the Indica, an outsider's

account, not Kautilya's treatise; Panini was a grammarian and the Arthashastra is not a collection of edicts; and Porus was the king Alexander fought and the Arthashastra is not praise-poetry, so the three distractors mismatch both the name and the work.

23. (C) The seven limbs are the king, the ministers, the territory with its people, the fort, the treasury, the army and the allies, and Kautilya stresses that, like a body, the state falters if any one limb is weak, so the correct option names them and gives the body analogy. The other lists mix up social classes, geographical features or military assets, none matching the saptanga, and they attach false reasons such as a lucky number, geography alone, or military power alone.

24. (C) The treasury and army are two limbs because they do different jobs, one supplying resources and the other supplying force, and that distinct-function reason holds even though the treasury funded the army. They were in fact used together, the army was paid from the treasury rather than only in grain, and the treasury was the state's, not the guilds', so the three distractors each rest on a false premise the question itself contradicts.

25. (C) The Mauryas split the empire into provinces under governors and officials answerable to the centre, and spies supplemented this by reporting from afar and watching the officials themselves, so the correct option names both the structure and the spies' purpose. Villages were not left wholly independent, guilds governed crafts rather than provinces, and no emperor could tour every village yearly; the distractors also wrongly make spies a substitute for the army, the currency, or the governors rather than a supplement.

26. (A) Regular taxes gave the steady income that paid the army, the officials and public works, the lifeblood of a lasting state, which is why the chapter stresses taxation over windfalls. Taxation was a normal source of revenue rather than chiefly a punishment, it filled the state treasury rather than the guilds' coffers, and far from replacing trade it depended on a thriving economy to yield revenue, so the three distractors misstate its purpose.

27. (A) Bindusara was the middle Mauryan ruler, son of Chandragupta and father of Ashoka; Megasthenes was the Greek ambassador who described the court; and Kautilya was the mentor and author of the Arthashastra, so the correct option matches each rightly. The other three shuffle these identities, for instance making Bindusara the Greek envoy or the founder, Megasthenes the mentor, or Kautilya the last Nanda, all of which scramble the well-known roles.

28. (B) Megasthenes, a foreign envoy, wrote the Indica as an outside observer's record, whereas Kautilya, the insider mentor, wrote the Arthashastra as a manual of governance, so the correct option names each work and its nature. The first distractor swaps the two authorships, neither work is a religious scripture, and Megasthenes wrote no praise-poetry

while the rock edicts were Ashoka's much later work, so the other options misassign the writings.

29. (D) The dhamma-mahamatras were Ashoka's officers charged with promoting and supervising his moral code among the people, which is why their title joins dhamma to the word for high officials. They were not frontier cavalry commanders, not tribute collectors, and not the stone-carvers of the edicts; those three duties belonged to other parts of the administration, so the distractors misplace their role.

30. (B) Administration carried the emperor's authority into regions he could never personally oversee, working alongside the army and treasury rather than displacing them, because force and funds were still indispensable, which corrects the teacher's claim. Officials did not exist to write praise-poetry, they helped collect taxes rather than abolish them, and they did not field private armies replacing the imperial one, so the three distractors invent roles the chapter does not give the administration.

31. (A) Ashoka's motive for the Kalinga war was conquest and expansion, and only the suffering it caused turned him toward Dhamma, so the student has cause and effect reversed, which the correct option fixes. The war certainly happened, so denying it is false; Kalinga's prior religion is not the point and is not stated as the reason; and there was no blanket religious ban on kings waging war, so the other corrections rest on inventions rather than the real reversal of order.

32. (B) Ashoka's own edicts confess his grief over the carnage at Kalinga, giving us his remorse directly in his words, which is the evidence the chapter cites. Megasthenes and Kautilya both belong to an earlier generation, before Ashoka's reign, so neither could record Kalinga, and a later commemorative temple is not the evidence the chapter relies on, so the three distractors point to sources that do not exist or predate the event.

33. (D) It was Ashoka's remorse over Kalinga that turned him from conquest to Dhamma, so without that remorse he would likely have kept warring and the moral edicts would never have been written, which is the chapter's logic. The empire would not have fallen instantly, Brahmi's much later decipherment is unrelated to Ashoka's feelings, and Chandragupta ruled generations earlier and could not be affected, so the three distractors assert effects the reasoning does not support.

34. (C) Dhamma was an ethical code calling for honesty, non-violence, tolerance and dutiful conduct, meant for all subjects whatever their faith, so the correct option describes it rightly. It was not a new religion replacing Buddhism, not a tax, and certainly not a doctrine of war; Ashoka used Dhamma to bind his peoples morally rather than to found a creed, raise revenue, or wage battles, so the three distractors mistake its very nature.

35. (B) Ashoka's empire stretched over almost all the subcontinent except the southern tip, while the northwest reaching toward Afghanistan lay firmly inside, so the correct

option names one true exclusion and one true inclusion. The Ganga plains held the capital Pataliputra and were inside, the northwest was included rather than excluded, and the east toward modern Bangladesh was also inside, so each distractor either excludes a region that was in fact part of the empire or wrongly includes the south.

36. (B) Ashoka cut his messages into rocks and pillars set up throughout the empire, a lasting and public medium that reached scattered populations, which is exactly why he earns the title. Relying on soldiers reciting would reach few and fade, printing did not yet exist, and a single central temple would draw only those nearby, so the three distractors describe means that could not achieve wide, durable communication.

37. (B) A language is what people speak and a script is the set of signs used to write it, so Prakrit the spoken tongue and Brahmi the writing system are different kinds of thing, which is the classic correction. Swapping the two makes Brahmi a language and Prakrit a script, calling both Greek scripts is doubly wrong, and denying that either is a script repeats the confusion, so the three distractors all worsen the error.

38. (C) Using everyday Prakrit let Ashoka's words reach ordinary subjects, and choosing stone made the messages lasting and openly visible for generations, so the correct option gives both real reasons. Sanskrit already existed and writing surfaces other than paper were known, Prakrit was the popular rather than a secret tongue and cost was not the driver, and any language can be inscribed while Brahmi was not restricted to stone, so the three distractors rest on false claims.

39. (C) Brahmi is the parent script of many later Indian writing systems and Prakrit was the language of common speech, so the correct option states both lasting facts. Brahmi is not the Roman alphabet and Prakrit was popular rather than a refined court tongue; Brahmi has in fact been deciphered and Prakrit was not a priestly secret; and Brahmi is a script rather than a spoken court language with Prakrit being a language rather than a script, so the three distractors reverse or falsify these roles.

40. (D) India adopted the Lion Capital that once topped Ashoka's pillar at Sarnath as its emblem, and the dharmachakra at the centre of the flag, the wheel of dharma standing for righteous law and the Buddha's teaching, comes from the same Mauryan art, so the correct option links all three. The Sanchi stupa, the Dhauli elephant and the dancing terracotta figure were not chosen as the emblem, and the flag's wheel is not a war-chariot wheel, a map of trade routes, or a sun symbol, so the three distractors misname both the emblem and the wheel's meaning.

41. (B) In architecture a capital is the sculpted top of a column, here the four-lion piece, and Ashoka set his pillar at Sarnath because it was the site of the Buddha's first sermon, so the correct option gets both the term and the reason. The capital is not a capital city, a treasury, or an edict, and Sarnath was not Ashoka's coronation site, the Kalinga battlefield

in Odisha, or where Chandragupta beat the Nandas in Magadha, so the three distractors confuse the term or misplace the site.

42. (A) From 232 BCE to about 185 BCE is roughly forty-seven years, so the empire fell within about half a century of Ashoka's death, and this swift decline illustrates the fragility the chapter stresses. Two centuries, a single year, and more than three hundred years all misjudge the gap, and they draw the wrong lesson, either of unusual stability, of instant collapse, or of long survival, none of which fits the arithmetic.

43. (D) The paradox is that an empire brings unity and wealth yet depends on force and tribute, so once the central power weakens far provinces seize the chance to break free and even mighty empires fall, which the correct option states together. Empires were in fact large and kept armies, so 'small and large' with 'no army' is false; they had subordinate kings and did collect tribute, contradicting the second option; and they spent heavily on armies, contradicting the third, so each distractor builds on a false premise.

44. (A) Rebellion is likeliest when central authority slackens under a weak ruler at the same time as the burden of tribute rises, giving both the opportunity and the grievance to revolt, which the correct option captures. A run of strong emperors keeps provinces in check, lighter tribute and peace reduce discontent, and better roads strengthen the centre's reach, so all three distractors describe conditions that would discourage rather than encourage breaking away.

45. (C) Because the edicts were set up across the territory Ashoka governed, mapping where they are found traces the reach of his empire and influence, which is what the spread reveals. The edicts are moral and administrative messages, not registers of Alexander's birth year, of market iron prices, or of guild counts, so the three distractors attribute to the inscriptions contents they never carried.

46. (A) Empires did not hold elections; the emperor's power came by conquest and succession, not by a vote, so 'holding regular elections to choose the emperor' is not one of the six supports and is the correct answer to this 'NOT' question. A strong army, communication networks, and support for art and learning are all genuine supports the chapter lists, so each of those three belongs and is therefore not the answer.

47. (A) Bindusara was the middle of the three great Mauryas, son of Chandragupta and father of Ashoka, so the correct option places him in the succession. He was not the mentor-author Kautilya, not the Greek envoy Megasthenes, and not the founder Chandragupta, so the three distractors hand him roles that belonged to other figures entirely.

48. (A) The chapter ties the Nandas' fall to lost popular loyalty under an oppressive king, so a just Dhana Nanda who kept that loyalty might have held on longer and resisted Chandragupta, which is the correct inference. A just Nanda has no bearing on Ashoka's

later birth, would not have let Alexander conquer all of India, which never happened for separate reasons, and has nothing to do with how many copies of the Arthashastra Kautilya wrote, so the three distractors draw unrelated conclusions.

49. (C) A planned, prosperous, food-secure city reflects officials organising it and the state marshalling resources, so it illustrates strong administration and control over resources working together, which is the correct option. The absence of an army or currency would weaken rather than build such a city, tribute alone without an economy could not sustain it, and refusing art and trade describes neglect rather than the prosperity shown, so the three distractors name the opposite of what the city demonstrates.

50. (A) Maintaining a large standing army drains the treasury, so it depends on a flourishing economy and reliable taxes to fund it, and an army with no money soon collapses, which is the chapter's argument. There was no rule barring the army from provinces, soldiers were paid rather than unpaid volunteers, and although tributaries had their own forces the emperor still kept his own army, so the three distractors each contradict how the chapter describes the army.

51. (D) The chapter's overarching message is that maintaining an empire is even harder than building one, which is why even the mighty Mauryas declined after their strongest rulers, so the correct option states the central lesson. Empires do not last forever, a lone strong emperor is not enough without the other supports, and tribute alone cannot rule without an army and administration, so the three distractors each contradict the chapter's conclusion.

52. (D) Communication networks overcome distance, carrying commands, soldiers and information quickly so the centre can direct far regions it cannot watch in person, a job an army by itself cannot do, which the correct option states. Fast messages do not defend a frontier without an army, communication is not chiefly for collecting tribute, and it has nothing to do with abolishing the currency, so the three distractors misstate what the network does.

53. (C) Imperium points to supreme power, and the chapter uses the word's origin to underline that an empire rests on one ruler wielding such power over many lands and subordinate rulers, which the correct option states. The Mauryas and Nandas were not ruled by Roman emperors, empires were not all named in Latin by their founders, and an empire is defined by layered supreme authority rather than mere wealth, so the three distractors miss the point of the etymology.

54. (C) Different coins and measures in each region means the empire lacks a common currency and standards, so cross-regional trade and even taxation grow harder and the economy weakens, which the correct option identifies. The army, communication networks and patronage of art are not what is described as missing here, so the three

distractors name supports the empire actually has and draw consequences that do not follow from the currency problem.

55. (B) Alexander overran the Persian Empire on his way east, but the Maurya empire had not yet been founded, coming into being only a few years after his departure under Chandragupta, so the correct option distinguishes the two. He did not conquer the Maurya empire, which did not exist, so the options pairing his conquest of it with or instead of Persia are false, and neither empire defeated and expelled him, so that option is false as well.

56. (A) Tributaries, satraps and officials are all devices for projecting the emperor's authority into regions he cannot personally rule, so the chapter ties them together as one connected solution to the problem of distance, which the correct option states. None of them was a method of choosing the next emperor, none existed to write praise-poetry, and they were instruments of collecting tribute and taxes rather than avoiding them, so the three distractors misread their shared purpose.

57. (D) The first fact shows guilds governing themselves in an orderly way, and the second shows kings allowing this, and the conclusion that fits both is that orderly, prosperous guilds boosted the trade that fed royal taxes, so leaving them alone served the king's interest. Soldiers did not run the guilds day to day, guilds organised craft and commerce rather than merely collecting tribute, and a body that fixes prices and elects a head is plainly not a rule-less family shop, so the three distractors contradict the very facts given.

58. (B) A tributary is a defeated king left on his throne in return for tribute, while a satrap is simply an appointee set to govern a province and owning no kingdom, so the correct option states the distinction precisely. The first distractor swaps the two definitions, neither role implies ruling more land than the overlord, and neither is fixed by ethnicity, so the three distractors reverse or invent the difference.

59. (A) The edicts are Ashoka's own public words and so best reveal his own thinking, while the Indica is a foreign envoy's account and so best provides an outsider's view, which the correct option matches rightly. The first distractor reverses the authorship, making the Indica Ashoka's and the edicts foreign; the second wrongly calls both Ashoka's own, denying any outside view; and the third wrongly calls both foreign reports, denying us Ashoka's direct voice, so each contradicts who wrote what.

60. (D) Chandragupta founded the empire about 321 BCE, his son Bindusara ruled next, then Ashoka fought the Kalinga war in the third century BCE, and the empire ended about 185 BCE, giving the order founder, Bindusara, Kalinga, end. Putting Bindusara before Chandragupta reverses father and son, putting Kalinga before Bindusara skips a generation, and putting the empire's end before the Kalinga war places the collapse before

an event that happened during the empire, so all three distractors break the internal sequence.